



MARKET MONITOR

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No. 88 – May 2021

From a global perspective, supply and demand fundamentals concerning the AMIS crops continue to point to a generally comfortable market situation. However, increasing uncertainties with regard to weather developments, macroeconomic conditions and the pandemic-driven health crisis have raised some concerns about the prospects for the months ahead. The steep rise in international prices of most agricultural commodities, coupled with food inflation that appears to be gaining ground in many countries, necessitates a more prudent interpretation of how food markets are evolving. In this context, an effective and well-functioning trade environment must be guaranteed in order to safeguard market stability and prevent excessive levels of price volatility.

Markets at a glance

	From previous forecast	From previous season
Wheat	n/a	▲
Maize	▼	▼
Rice	▲	▲
Soybeans	▲	▼

▲ Easing ■ Neutral ▼ Tightening

The **Market Monitor** is a product of the Agricultural Market Information System (AMIS). It covers international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations and entities that form the AMIS Secretariat.

Feature article

Towards economic and trade recovery: a multi-disciplinary approach is needed

At its 21 April meeting, the AMIS Rapid Response Forum (RRF) took stock of the uncertain economic and trade environment caused by the global pandemic. For 2021, IMF estimates point to a 6 per cent world economic growth while WTO projects an 8 per cent rebound in the volume of merchandise trade. However, renewed outbreaks already threaten to undermine this outlook. A resilient, inclusive, and sustainable global economic and trade recovery remains conditional upon the pace and successful deployment of vaccines worldwide. Defeating the socioeconomic impacts of the pandemic and fully restoring trade flows will require strong international policy dialogue, information exchange, cooperation mechanisms and coordinated solutions in a range of WTO disciplines. On-going efforts to strengthen existing multilateral trade rules would contribute to reactivate the global economy.

In reforming agriculture trade disciplines, the well-known overall policy spectrum remains under mandated negotiations aimed at a market-oriented trading system. While government assistance in the form of direct payments, income support, public stockholding, and food assistance continues to be rolled out to counter health, social, economic, and food security impacts, dismantling harmful support policies remains a clear priority. A multilateral outcome to exempt WFP's humanitarian food procurement from export restrictions is also potentially within reach.

A plethora of concerns continue to be raised on restrictive SPS measures, including import restrictions, pesticide policies and maximum residue levels, testing and certification for GMO-derived food, listing and registration requirements imposed on export establishments, delays in approval procedures, COVID-related port-of-entry rejections, reportedly applied without sufficient scientific evidence. Structured peer review and monitoring mechanisms are proving instrumental in resolving

tensions, building common ground, and hence contributing to regulatory convergence. In addition, fresh [discussions](#) were launched on ways to reaffirm the fundamental principles of the SPS Agreement in relation to the challenges facing sustainable agriculture in the 21st century.

On the ground, the Standards and Trade Development Facility ([STDF](#)) proactively catalyses public and private support to assist farmers, producers, traders and governments in developing countries to meet SPS requirements, based on international standards; identifies and promotes good practices to improve SPS capacity development outcomes on cross-cutting topics, including public private partnerships, use of evidence to prioritize SPS investments, electronic SPS certification and good regulatory practice. Since COVID-19 was declared a global pandemic, the STDF introduced a range of [actions](#) to manage the risk of COVID-19 across its work and emphasized the [importance of investments](#) to support economic recovery and longer-term resilience against future outbreaks of pests and diseases.

While the pandemic accelerated countries' adoption of IT-based tools and technologies, the progressive implementation of the Trade Facilitation Agreement is expected to further expedite the movement, release and clearance of goods, foster cooperation between customs authorities, and streamline customs management. An enabling and inclusive legal framework for e-commerce would also support the emerging digital economy. In this regard, the recent finalization of a [“clean text”](#) on e-signatures and authentication constituted a major breakthrough.

As outlined above, a multi-disciplinary policy perspective is useful to comprehend the potential synergies and benefits to be gained from efforts under way to update the WTO rule book, meet current and future health, economic and social challenges, enhance the predictability of global supply chains, and create a level playing field in agricultural trade.

World supply-demand outlook

- **Wheat** production in 2021 to increase above last year's level to a new record, supported by higher outputs in several countries and a strong rebound in the EU more than offsetting declines in Australia, Canada, and the Russian Federation.
- Utilization in 2021/22 to increase, largely driven by growth in food consumption and industrial use, whereas feed use of wheat could fall slightly short of the 2020/21 record level.
- Trade in 2021/22 (July/June) may be heading for a contraction on reduced import prospects from China, Morocco and Pakistan but shipments from Argentina and the EU are likely to increase.
- Stocks (ending in 2022) likely to rise for a third consecutive season, reaching a new peak; but the bulk of the increase is expected to be concentrated in China.

- **Maize*** 2020 production raised marginally on upward revisions in Turkey and several countries in Africa.
- Utilization in 2020/21 revised up, mostly reflecting higher estimates for feed use in China and the US.
- Trade for 2020/21 (July/June) is forecast to expand by 7 percent, largely driven by record purchases by China.
- Stocks (ending 2021) scaled down since last month, mostly reflecting downward revisions of inventories in the US because of stronger domestic demand for feed and industrial use.

- **Rice** production in 2020 trimmed as an upward revision to output in Madagascar is offset by cuts for the Democratic People's Republic of Korea and Guinea.
- Utilization in 2020/21 still seen expanding to a record high, despite a slight downward adjustment, namely to food use expectations.
- Trade in 2021 (January-December) essentially unchanged m/m, with a revival in imports by Bangladesh and West African countries behind much of the expected 6.4 percent y/y expansion.
- Stocks (2020/21 carry-out) raised slightly, as historical revisions to stocks in Taiwan, alongside other smaller upward revisions, outweigh cuts to carry-overs, namely in Japan.

- **Soybean** 2020/21 production forecast raised slightly, mostly reflecting an upward revision for Brazil, now pointing to a 7.5 percent rise in global output compared to 2019/20.
- Utilization in 2020/21 virtually unchanged m/m, as a downward adjustment for the US is compensated by higher forecasts for Argentina, Brazil and a number of other countries.
- Trade in 2020/21 (Oct/Sep) raised marginally on higher than earlier anticipated shipments by Brazil and the US.
- Stocks (2020/21 carry-out) adjusted upwards, reflecting a higher forecast for Brazil, although global closing inventories are still seen dropping to a seven-year low.

Wheat	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2020/21 est	2021/22 f'cast 6 May		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Apr	2020/21 est	2021/22 f'cast 29 Apr	
Stocks	Prod.	774.6	778.8	763.9	776.5	774.3	790.4	
		640.4	643.3	630.3	642.2	640.0	654.4	
	Supply	1,051.8	1,063.6	1,047.2	1,076.5	1,052.7	1,079.8	
		894.5	797.3	773.9	790.6	788.7	811.9	
	Utiliz.	763.3	770.0	747.2	781.0	763.3	781.7	
		622.4	634.5	621.2	631.0	622.3	654.4	
	Trade	188.0	184.5	191.4	196.3	189.3	185.2	
		178.0	175.5	186.0	185.8	179.1	177.6	
	Stocks	284.9	293.5	300.0	295.5	289.4	298.1	
		154.0	153.9	148.4	150.1	156.2	162.5	
Maize	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 8 Apr	2020/21 f'cast 6 May	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Apr	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 29 Apr	
Stocks	Prod.	1,138.7	1,154.8	1,155.7	1,116.5	1,137.1	1,124.8	1,140.1
		878.0	894.1	895.0	855.7	876.4	864.1	879.4
	Supply	1,462.8	1,457.0	1,458.7	1,437.6	1,440.0	1,451.0	1,436.8
		1,040.8	1,046.1	1,047.8	966.6	978.8	985.7	984.4
	Utiliz.	1,156.1	1,179.4	1,183.6	1,134.6	1,156.2	1,154.2	1,165.6
		876.8	887.1	888.3	856.6	867.2	871.4	874.7
	Trade	174.4	186.5	186.7	175.0	185.1	174.2	185.3
		169.1	166.5	166.7	167.4	161.1	164.9	160.3
	Stocks	303.0	279.0	275.6	303.0	283.9	296.8	271.2
		152.8	140.4	137.0	102.5	87.7	104.9	84.6
Rice	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 8 Apr	2020/21 f'cast 6 May	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Apr	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 29 Apr	
Stocks	Prod.	503.0	513.6	513.2	497.7	504.2	498.7	503.6
		359.4	368.5	368.1	351.0	355.9	352.0	355.3
	Supply	688.7	696.3	695.9	674.2	682.1	674.3	677.3
		439.7	447.8	447.4	412.5	417.3	418.5	419.2
	Utiliz.	504.4	514.1	513.8	496.3	504.3	500.5	504.0
		358.5	366.2	365.7	351.1	355.3	354.1	355.5
	Trade	45.4	48.2	48.4	45.0	46.0	44.0	45.8
		42.3	45.4	45.3	41.8	43.1	40.9	43.0
	Stocks	182.7	182.7	183.1	177.9	177.7	173.8	173.3
		79.3	80.5	80.9	61.4	61.3	61.3	63.5
Soybeans	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 8 Apr	2020/21 f'cast 6 May	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Apr	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 29 Apr	
Stocks	Prod.	338.2	361.3	363.5	339.0	361.8	338.3	361.7
		320.1	341.7	343.9	320.9	342.2	320.2	342.1
	Supply	401.4	415.9	418.1	453.5	457.9	402.6	413.5
		372.3	376.9	379.1	415.9	411.5	363.8	364.7
	Utiliz.	360.0	375.3	375.4	357.0	371.3	350.8	366.6
		251.9	256.3	256.5	247.8	254.6	239.8	248.7
	Trade	169.2	169.5	170.3	165.1	169.7	169.8	171.2
		70.7	68.8	69.6	66.4	66.9	68.3	68.5
	Stocks	54.9	40.1	41.2	96.4	83.7	51.8	46.8
		35.5	19.7	20.7	69.6	54.1	22.5	13.2

in million tonnes

i Data shown in the second rows refer to world aggregates without China; world trade data refer to exports and world trade without China excludes exports to China.

To review and compare data, by country and commodity, across three main sources, go to <https://app.amis-outlook.org/#/market-database/compare-sources>

Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies.

*The 2020/21 AMIS-FAO world maize production forecast includes southern hemisphere maize crops harvested in 2020 whereas IGC and USDA include southern hemisphere maize crops to be harvested in 2021 in their 2020/21 world production numbers.

For more information see Explanatory notes on the last page of this report.

Revisions (FAO-AMIS) to 2020/21 forecasts since the previous report

in thousand tonnes

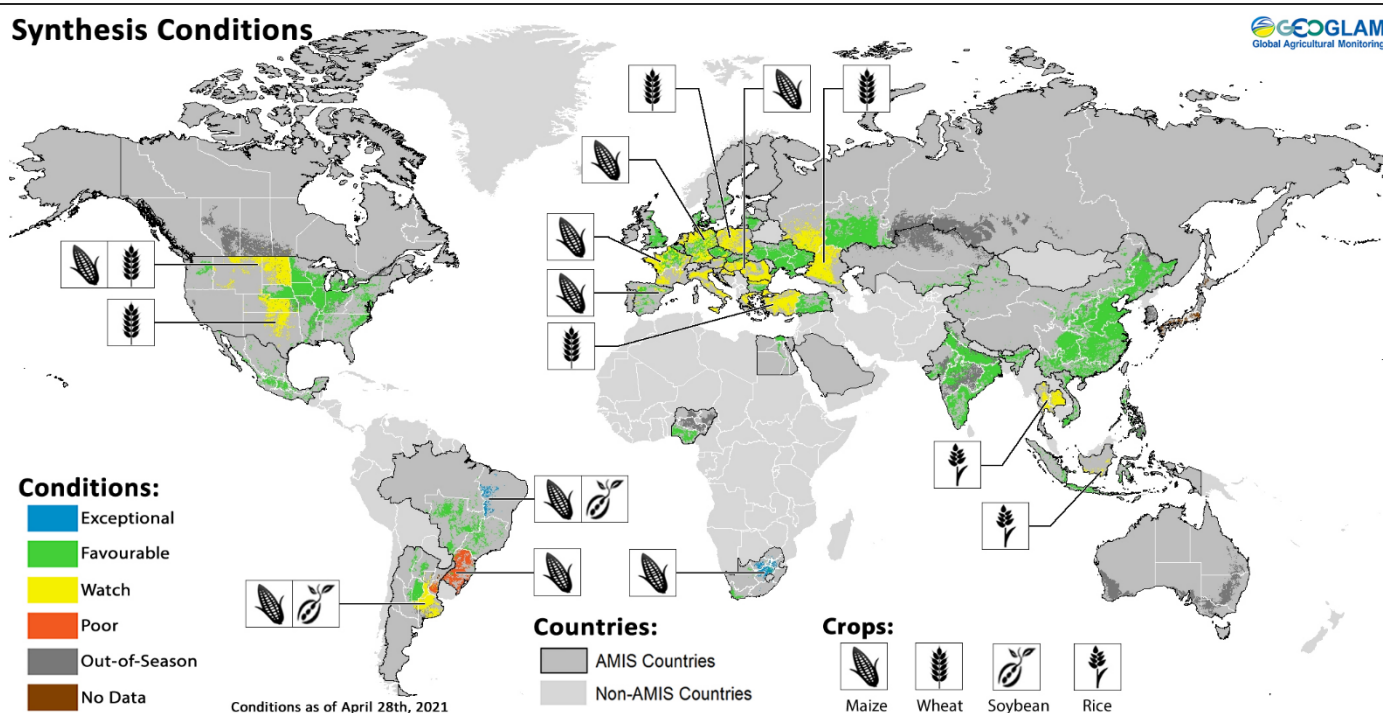
	WHEAT					MAIZE				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	343	-4	288	-10	886	875	166	4204	176	-3464
Total AMIS	-106	-300	148	-200	-1026	448	-897	4174	30	-3202
Argentina	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Australia	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	4	-	-
Brazil	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Canada	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	100	-100	-100
China Mainland	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3000	-	-
Egypt	-	-500	-	-	-900	-	-	-	-	-
EU	-	-400	-	-	-400	-	-1000	-1000	150	-150
India	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	904
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-50	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	2	-	-	-	2	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-50	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-	-3	-	-53	-	50
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-	-	-200	-200	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-8	-	192	-	-150	3	-	-200	-	-96
Russian Fed.	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Saudi Arabia	-100	-	-	-	-100	-3	-	-3	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	70	-70	-
Turkey	-	400	500	-200	100	469	-	469	-100	-
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
UK	-	-	-	-	-	-	300	300	-	-
US	-	-	-694	-	422	-	-	1905	-	-3810
Viet Nam	-	200	200	-	-	-18	-	-218	200	-

	RICE					SOYBEANS				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	-400	232	-350	171	419	2247	927	112	849	1107
Total AMIS	-27	275	205	171	-84	2537	531	-64	1148	1070
Argentina	-	-	-	-	-	-	200	400	-	-100
Australia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	-	-20	34	160	-	2540	-	264	790	1176
Canada	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
China Mainland	-	300	212	50	-	-	0	-100	-	100
Egypt	-	110	10	-	100	-3	-	27	-	-30
EU	-	-20	-110	-	-110	-	-	-	-	-
India	-	-	-	-	-	-	66	200	-134	-
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	0	-	147	-	-210	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-14	20	-4	11	-15	-	-	100	-	-100
Nigeria	0	-40	-20	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-13	-100	-3	-	-10	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-	-24	-	39	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-	-	100	100	-	-
Turkey	-	-40	25	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	-	10	-	-	10	-	30	53	-58	6
UK	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
US	-	-25	-62	-50	112	-	10	-1210	550	-
Viet Nam	-	80	-	-	-	-	125	102	-	18

Crop monitor

Crop conditions in AMIS countries (as of 28 April)

Synthesis Conditions



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of 28 April. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. **Only crops that are in other-than-favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.**

Conditions at a glance

Wheat - In the northern hemisphere, spring wheat sowing is just beginning while areas of concern for winter wheat remain for the Russian Federation, western Turkey, the US, and Canada.

Maize - In the southern hemisphere, harvesting of spring-planted and some summer-planted crops is progressing. In the northern hemisphere, sowing is beginning with delays in Europe due to recent cold weather.

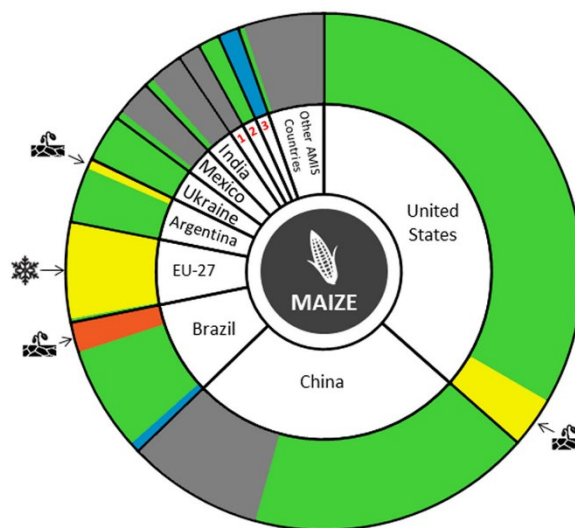
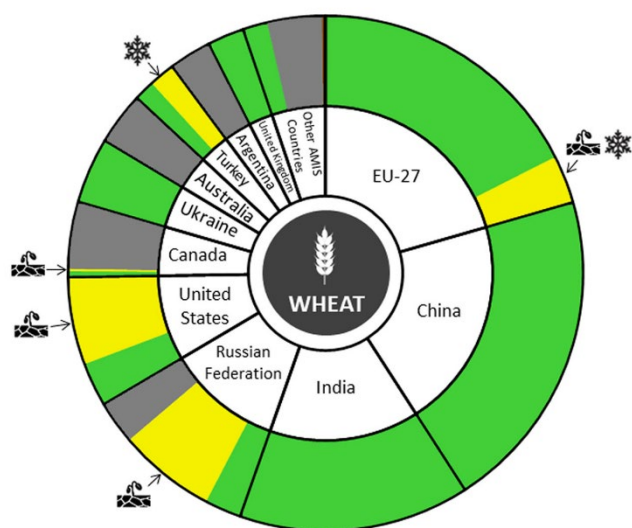
Rice – Sowing is continuing in China while the harvesting of Rabi rice is beginning in India. In Southeast Asia, harvesting is ongoing for wet-season rice in Indonesia and dry-season rice in the northern countries. Harvesting is wrapping up in Brazil.

Soybeans - In the southern hemisphere, harvesting is coming to an end in Brazil and ongoing in Argentina. In the northern hemisphere, sowing is just beginning in the US and Ukraine.

Weakening La Niña

The current La Niña is weakening. A transition to neutral El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) is expected in the next month (81 percent chance for May to July).

Long-range forecasts made at this time of year have a high level of uncertainty. However, IRI/CPC forecasts in April indicated about equal chances that another La Niña event might develop (46 percent chance), or neutral ENSO conditions will occur (41 percent chance) during October to December 2021.

Conditions:**Drivers:**

Canada¹, Russian Federation², South Africa³

Wheat

In the **EU**, conditions are generally favourable for winter wheat with some spot areas affected by dry and cold conditions. In the **UK**, conditions are favourable despite a slowing of crop development due to recent cold weather. In **Ukraine**, conditions are favourable with some improvement in the south owing to good rainfall over the past few months. In the **Russian Federation**, winter wheat conditions have improved thanks to recent rainfall. However, some of the crop, particularly in the central district, will need to be resown. Spring wheat sowing is just beginning under favourable conditions. In **Turkey**, rainfall has mitigated earlier dry conditions; however, recent cold weather has impacted the western part of the country. In **China**, conditions are favourable for winter wheat in the critical development stage and as the sowing of spring wheat begins. In **India**, harvesting is wrapping up under favourable conditions. There is an increase in total sown area compared to last year. In the **US**, winter wheat remains under watch conditions in the northern and southern Great Plains due to dryness. Spring wheat sowing is about halfway complete and also under watch conditions due to dryness. In **Canada**, winter wheat conditions are favourable in the main producing province of Ontario, while dryness persists in the Prairie provinces.

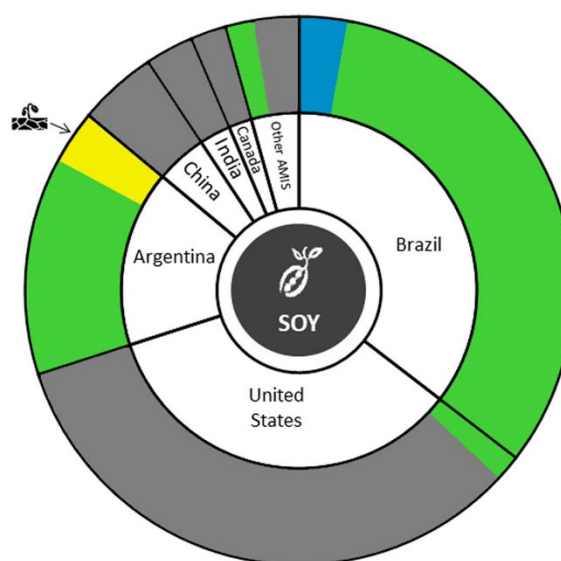
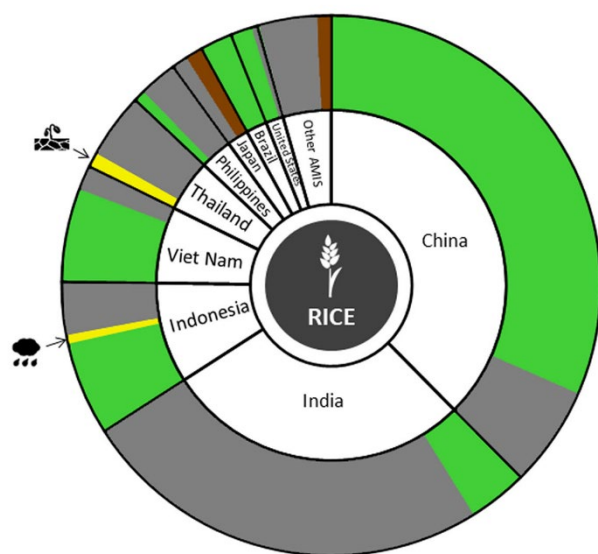
Maize

In **Brazil**, harvest is continuing for the spring-planted (smaller season) crop with poor conditions in the main producing South region due to earlier dryness. Conversely, conditions are favourable in the Central-West and the Southeast regions, while exceptional in the Northeast region. The summer-planted (larger season) crop is under favourable conditions with most of the crop entering the critical vegetative to reproductive stage. There is an estimated increase in total sown area compared to last year. In **Argentina**, harvesting of the early-planted crop (usually larger season) and the late-planted crop (usually smaller season) is ongoing after some delays due to rainfall and the prioritization of soybean harvesting. Conditions are generally favourable; however, yields are very heterogeneous as a result of uneven rainfall during the season. In **India**, harvesting is wrapping up for the Rabi crop under favourable conditions. In **South Africa**, harvesting is progressing well under exceptional conditions. In **Mexico**, the autumn-winter crop (smaller season) is under favourable conditions. In the **US**, conditions are generally favourable as sowing is well underway, particularly in the southern parts of the *corn belt*. In **China**, sowing of the spring-planted crop is beginning under favourable conditions. In the **EU**, conditions are mixed as cold and dry weather in the northern and eastern parts of Europe is delaying sowing and crop development. In **Ukraine**, sowing is beginning under favourable conditions. In the **Russian Federation**, sowing is just beginning under favourable conditions.



Pie chart description: Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average), with the main producing countries (95 percent of production) shown individually and the remaining 5 percent grouped into the "Other AMIS Countries" category. Sections within each country are weighted by the sub-national production statistics (5-year average) of the respective country and accounts for multiple cropping seasons (i.e. spring and winter wheat).

The late vegetative through to reproductive crop growth stages are generally the most sensitive periods for crop development.

Conditions:**Drivers:****Rice**

In **China**, sowing of single-season and early-season rice is ongoing under favourable conditions. In **India**, Rabi rice is under favourable conditions as harvesting begins. In **Indonesia**, harvesting of wet-season rice is entering the fourth month under generally favourable conditions owing to good rainfall and sunlight during the critical flowering stage. In **Viet Nam**, conditions are favourable across the country for the winter-spring (dry-season) crop as harvesting continues in the Mekong River Delta. Sowing of the summer-autumn (wet-season) crop in the Mekong River Delta is progressing at a good pace under favourable conditions. In **Thailand**, harvesting is ongoing for dry-season rice under mixed conditions across the country due to a lack of irrigation water during most of the season followed by recent moisture damage from a storm in the north to central regions. In the **Philippines**, harvesting of dry-season rice is ongoing under favourable conditions. Crops in some provinces of Visayas and Mindanao have recovered from earlier storm damage. In **Brazil**, harvest is wrapping up under favourable conditions. In the **US**, sowing is progressing under favourable conditions.

Soybeans

In **Brazil**, harvesting is wrapping up under favourable conditions across most of the country and with exceptional conditions in the Northeast region. Despite the delayed sowing due to the lack of rains, there is an increase in the total sown area compared to last year. Yields across the country are in line with the five-year average, with above-average yields in the Northeast region. In **Argentina**, both the early-planted crop (larger season) and the late-planted crop (smaller season) are now harvesting after suffering some delays due to earlier adverse weather. Conditions remain quite mixed due to the uneven amount and timing of rains throughout the season across the country. In the **US**, sowing is just beginning in the southern states under favourable conditions. In **Ukraine**, sowing is beginning under favourable conditions with ample soil moisture.

Information on crop conditions in non-AMIS countries can be found in the [GEOGLAM Early Warning Crop Monitor](#), published 6 May 2021

Policy developments

Wheat

- On 19 April, through Resolution 60/2021, **Argentina** imposed additional information and registration requirements on exporters of grain, beef and dairy products in a bid to tame inflation.
- On 14 April, the **EU** notified the WTO of proposed Maximum Residue Limits (MRLs) for *ergot sclerotia* and *ergot alkaloids*, which are used on wheat (G/SPS/N/EU/479).
- On 1 April, the Ministry of Industry in **Indonesia** notified the WTO of a mandatory technical regulation (*Decree of Minister of Industry No. 1 Year 2021*) requiring the implementation of a national standard quality for wheat flour (G/TBT/N/IDN/1/Add.5).
- On 16 April, the Central Bank of **Nigeria** decided to cut off the supply of foreign currency to importers of wheat and sugar, amid concerns over the domestic recession and rising food prices. The addition of wheat and sugar to the foreign exchange restriction list comes as part of a broader policy shift in Nigeria towards self-sufficiency.

Maize

- On 10 April, the **US** Department of Agriculture (USDA) notified the WTO of revisions to the US grading standards for frozen maize on the cob. These revisions took effect on 8 April 2021.

Soybeans

- On 1 April, **Japan's** Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare notified the WTO of proposed revisions to pesticide MRLs for *fenpropathrin*, which is used on soybeans (G/SPS/N/JPN/835; deadline for comments 31 May). On 7 April, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs notified the adoption of pesticide MRLs for *pyriproxyfen*, which is used on several products including soybeans (G/SPS/N/JPN/788/Add.1).

Rice

- On 9 April, **Brazil** approved new phytosanitary requirements for *Oryza sativa* rice grown in MERCOSUR countries (MERCOSUR/GMC/RES. No. 07/20).
- On 14 April, **Canada** notified the WTO of proposed MRLs for inorganic arsenic in rice-based foods intended specifically for infants and young children (G/SPS/N/CAN/1383).
- On 29 April 2021, **Mexico** approved a rice tariff quota of 75 000 tonnes at zero tariff until the end of the year for

Brazilian paddy rice, an increase from the 30 000 tonnes quota implemented in June 2020.

- Further to the implementation of its Rice Tariffication Law, on 20 April the Department of Agriculture in the **Philippines** announced the provision of PHP 15 billion (USD 310.5 million) worth of farm machinery and equipment to rice farmers in 2021. Such support will be granted to about one million farmers in the framework of the Rice Competitiveness Enhancement Fund.
- On 27 April 2021, the Ministry of Commerce in **Thailand** decided to cut the export tariff for white fragrant and 100 percent parboiled rice with the EU and the UK. The tariff will be reduced from THD 2500 (USD 79.6) per tonne to THB 1500 (USD 47.8) per tonne for the EU and to THB 1200 (USD 38.2) per tonne for the UK.

Across the board

- On 20 April, the Executive Management Committee (GECEX) of **Brazil's** Chamber of Foreign Trade suspended import duties for maize, soybeans, soybean oil and soybean meal (GECEX RESOLUTION NO. 189). The duty suspensions shall apply from 27 April until 31 December 2021.
- On 27 April, the **European** Parliament approved a motion to ratify the EU-UK Trade and Cooperation Agreement (TCA), which is now set to come into effect as from 1 May. The EU-UK Partnership Council, the body responsible to oversee the implementation of the TCA, is now expected to be established.
- On 17 April, the **French** Prime Minister announced the provision of domestic support worth EUR 1.2 billion (USD 1.4 billion) to assist farmers whose crops suffered severe frost damage in April. The support will take the form of emergency credit facilities, tax breaks and exemptions from social contributions.
- On 8 April, the **US** and **China** mutually agreed to extend to 29 June 2021 the reasonable period of time for China to implement WTO's recommendations and rulings with respect to the administration of China's tariff quota access commitments for wheat, rice and maize (WT/DS517/18. See also December 2020 issue of the AMIS Market Monitor).
- On 21 April, **China's** Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Affairs released new guidelines to reduce the amount of maize and soymeal used in meal for pig and chicken maize and soymeal feed. Alternative crop sources were proposed to substitute maize feed (e.g., wheat, sorghum, barley, rice and cassava) and soymeal (e.g., canola cake, rapeseed meal, cottonseed meal, peanut meal, sunflower



AMIS Policy database

Visit the AMIS Policy database at: <http://statistics.amis-outlook.org/policy/>

The AMIS Policy database gathers information on trade measures and domestic measures related to the four AMIS crops (wheat, maize, rice, and soybeans) as well as biofuels. The design of this database allows comparisons across countries, across commodities and across policies for selected periods of time.

Only AMIS participants are marked in **bold**.

meal, distillers dried grains, palm meal, flax meal, sesame meal and other maize processing by-products).

- On 19 April, the **European** Commission notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs for several plant protection products used on wheat, maize and rice (G/SPS/N/EU/395/Add.1; EU/443/Add.1).
- On 23 April, due to the COVID-19 resurgence, the government of **India** announced that it will distribute 5kg per person of free food grains to the 800 million beneficiaries of the National Food Security Act in May and June. These grains will be in addition to their normal entitlement.
- On 1 April, **Japan** notified the WTO of proposed new pesticide MRLs for *chloropicrin*, *kasugamycin*, *prochloraz* and *validamycin*, which are used on all crops (G/SPS/N/JPN/834; JPN/836; JPN/838; JPN/839). On 7 April, new pesticide MRLs were also adopted for *azoxystrobin*, *bixafen*, *cyflufenamid* and *pyrifluquinazon*, which are used on wheat, maize and soybeans

(G/SPS/N/JPN/784/Add.1; 785/Add.1; 786/Add.1; 787/Add.1).

- On 28 April 2021, the **Russian Federation** is considering lowering its export tax on soybeans from 30 percent to 20 percent, but not less than USD 100 per tonne. The current tax is valid until 30 June, and the new tax, if confirmed, would be implemented from 1 July 2021 until September 2022.

Trade Junctures and Logistics

- The recent resurgence of international trade flows has impacted various supply chain and logistical services in **US** ports along the West Coast and the Gulf of Mexico, including the ports of Los Angeles and Long Beach. Disruptions in warehousing, trucking, rail service, inland and ocean terminals, container availability, and vessel service significantly affected the volume of containerized US agricultural exports.

International prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Apr 2021 Average*	Change M/M	Y/Y
GOI	270	+ 2.2 %	+ 42.4 %
Wheat	225	+ 0.4 %	+ 17.2 %
Maize	284	+ 5.7 %	+ 65.7 %
Rice	189	- 2.7 %	- 3.0 %
Soybeans	275	+ 2.6 %	+ 63.1 %

*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

Wheat

After a volatile month, world wheat export prices were little-changed in April, as initial weakness was outweighed by strong gains later in the month, boosted by uncertainty about the impact of less-than-ideal conditions for crops in parts of the northern hemisphere. Concerns centred on widespread dryness across North America, parts of Europe and the Black Sea region, while cold weather in some areas in mid-April was also seen as a potential threat to yields. Strong price increases for maize added to upward momentum, as wheat became more attractively-priced in feed rations. This was underscored by a number of wheat import purchases by feed makers in Far East Asia at significant price discounts to maize.

Maize

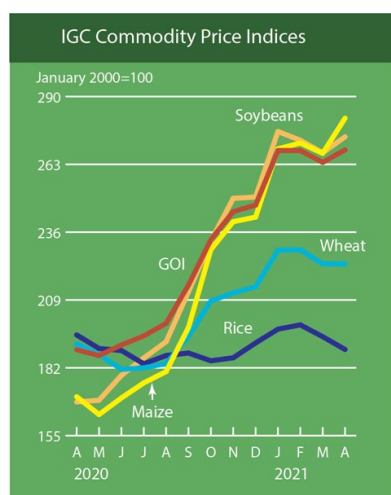
Amid tightening global supply prospects, maize export prices rose strongly, reaching an eight-year peak. Gains in the US (Gulf) were especially pronounced, tied to smaller than expected planting intentions data, solid overseas buying interest and firmer local cash markets. Worries about deteriorating production prospects in Brazil also underpinned, as traders saw the potential for additional US export demand. Although fob values in Argentina were also higher, mounting harvest pressure and brisk farmer selling contributed to a late-month decline, leading to a sizeable discount to competing origins. Seasonally tighter availabilities and slow country movement contributed to modestly firmer prices in Ukraine.

Rice

International rice prices mostly weakened m/m amid improving supplies and soft buying interest. In Viet Nam, offers fell as main (winter/spring) crop harvesting boosted availabilities, while demand remained slow as buyers largely preferred more competitively priced origins. Thai quotes declined as high freight rates discouraged buyers from concluding purchases, while Indian offers were little changed, albeit as a worsening second wave of COVID-19 curtailed market activity. In the Americas, new crop arrivals weighed on prices in Argentina, while prospects for a much reduced 2021/22 crop underpinned white rice and medium grain offers in the US.

Soybeans

Average soybean values strengthened m/m. While the advancing harvesting in Brazil pressured at times, this was more than offset by support from tightening US old crop supplies, coupled with strength in grains, rapeseed/canola and vegetable oils. More recently, however, ideas that US sowings in 2021/22 could exceed official expectations mildly weighed on sentiment. In addition to gains in the US market, fob quotations in Brazil were underpinned by solid international demand after an initial sluggish start to the season, while delays to harvesting of what is anticipated to be a disappointing outturn provided support in Argentina.



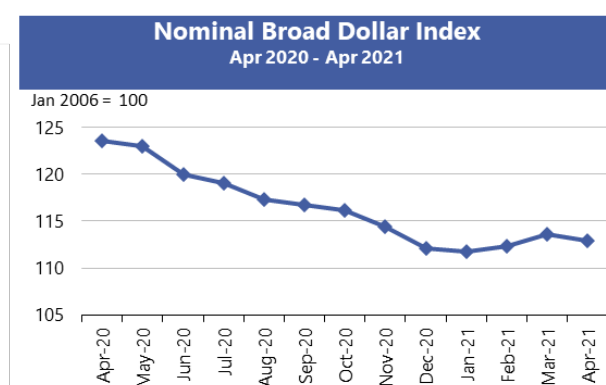
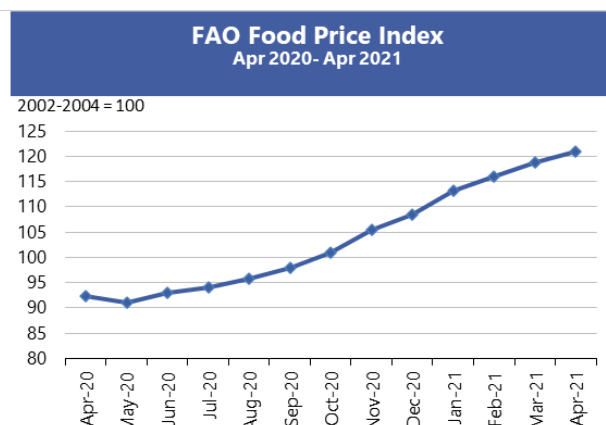
		IGC commodity price indices				
		GOI	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(..... January 2000 = 100)				
2020	April	189.2	191.5	170.5	195.1	168.4
	May	186.9	187.3	163.4	189.7	169.1
	June	191.1	181.4	170.0	188.9	179.0
	July	194.7	182.0	176.0	183.6	185.9
	August	199.7	183.7	180.5	186.9	192.4
	September	215.0	194.5	198.1	187.9	212.3
	October	233.0	208.6	229.1	184.8	232.5
	November	244.2	211.8	240.2	186.0	249.5
	December	246.8	214.3	242.0	191.9	250.0
	2021 January	268.5	228.8	269.2	197.4	276.1
	February	268.5	229.0	271.5	199.1	272.6
	March	263.8	223.4	267.4	194.4	267.6
	April	270.4	225.2	284.2	189.2	275.3

Selected export prices, currencies, and indices



Daily quotations of selected export prices						
	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Month ago (2)	Year ago (3)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (3)
..... USD/tonne						
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	30-Apr	312	257	232	21.4%	34.5%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	30-Apr	317	241	141	31.5%	124.7%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	30-Apr	477	507	538	-5.9%	-11.3%
Soybeans (US No.2, Yellow)	30-Apr	606	528	337	14.8%	79.8%

AMIS Countries' Currencies Against US Dollar				
AMIS Countries	Currency	Apr 2021 Average	Monthly Change	Annual Change
Argentina	ARS	92.7	-1.8%	-41.3%
Australia	AUD	1.3	-0.1%	18.1%
Brazil	BRL	5.6	1.3%	-4.8%
Canada	CAD	1.3	0.5%	11.0%
China	CNY	6.5	-0.1%	7.8%
Egypt	EGP	15.7	0.1%	0.4%
EU	EUR	0.8	0.6%	9.2%
India	INR	74.5	-2.4%	2.1%
Indonesia	IDR	14,528.6	-1.0%	7.4%
Japan	JPY	109.0	-0.3%	-1.1%
Kazakhstan	KZT	430.6	-2.3%	0.5%
Rep. Korea	KRW	1,117.9	1.1%	8.5%
Mexico	MXN	20.0	3.5%	17.0%
Nigeria	NGN	380.6	0.0%	-5.7%
Philippines	PHP	48.5	0.2%	4.3%
Russian Fed.	RUB	76.0	-2.1%	-1.5%
Saudi Arabia	SAR	3.8	0.0%	0.2%
South Africa	ZAR	14.4	3.8%	22.5%
Thailand	THB	31.3	-1.8%	4.0%
Turkey	TRY	8.2	-6.2%	-19.0%
UK	GBP	0.7	-0.1%	10.3%
Ukraine	UAH	27.9	-0.5%	-2.7%
Viet Nam	VND	23,068.8	-0.1%	1.7%



Source: US Federal Reserve

Futures market (US)

Futures Prices – nearby in USD per tonne

	Apr-21 Average	Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	245	5.0%	23.4%
Maize	243	11.4%	92.0%
Rice	289	0.6%	-13.9%
Soybeans	538	3.6%	73.7%

Source: CME

Historical Volatility – 30 Days, nearby

	Monthly Averages		
	Apr-21	Mar-21	Apr-20
Wheat	25.3%	28.4%	31.3%
Maize	27.3%	26.1%	24.9%
Rice	15.0%	12.8%	34.4%
Soybeans	23.1%	19.0%	19.4%

Future Prices

Following a pause during March, futures prices for wheat, maize and soybeans, rose to new multi-year highs, posting limit price moves near month-end. Declining US inventories, a return to economic growth and unprecedented demand from China pushed prices higher while amplifying the level of weather premiums in advance of the summer growing season. Traders cited dry weather in the Brazilian safrinha maize area as also supportive, but a spate of Argentinian licenses registered for maize exports late in month delivered a counterweight to export prices. Rice futures were virtually unchanged m/m. In exogenous markets, the US dollar index dropped from .93 to .90 m/m which helped underpin commodity prices in general. Crude oil prices remained fairly steady hovering above the USD 60 per barrel mark as the US economy continued to show growth. Some analysts noted, however, that commodity prices were reflatting across the globe, citing the loose monetary conditions prevailing since COVID-19 was declared a pandemic. Prices for wheat, maize, and soybeans were substantially higher y/y at 23.4, 92.0 and 73.7 percent respectively while rice was lower by 14.1 percent.

Volumes and volatility

Trade volumes rose for wheat, maize and soybeans both m/m and y/y as the sharp rally at month-end drew heavy activity in all three commodities. It remains to be seen whether the raising of position limits by over 75 percent by the CME affected volume levels since only the wheat volume reached a monthly record number. Historical and implied volatility showed only small overall changes m/m and y/y. However, volatility levels spiked at month-end, reaching above the 40 mark for wheat and maize.

Basis levels and transport

Domestic basis levels in the US were firmer m/m, indicating a growing scarcity of domestic supplies. In Illinois, average quotes to local elevators were plus USD 1.0 per tonne for maize over the May futures, with some elevators reportedly bidding double digit levels for spot

shipment. Illinois soybean basis levels were also firm at plus USD 5.0 per tonne over the May futures prices. In Iowa, maize and soybean bids were minus USD 6.5 and minus USD 6.0, respectively. Soft red wheat bids to flour mills were mostly unchanged and discounted to May futures. Maize and soybean bids delivered gulf, despite the brisk export pace eased slightly to USD 27 and USD 26 per tonne over respective futures m/m. Soft red wheat values also slipped to around USD 33 per tonne over the May futures. Barge freight on the Illinois River edged lower to about USD 17 per tonne. The USDA reported that exports for maize and soybeans were continuing at a robust pace, with shipped and unshipped totals now surpassing the official estimates for the entire crop year with 4 months remaining. Wheat exports and unshipped totals approximated last year's totals.

Forward curves

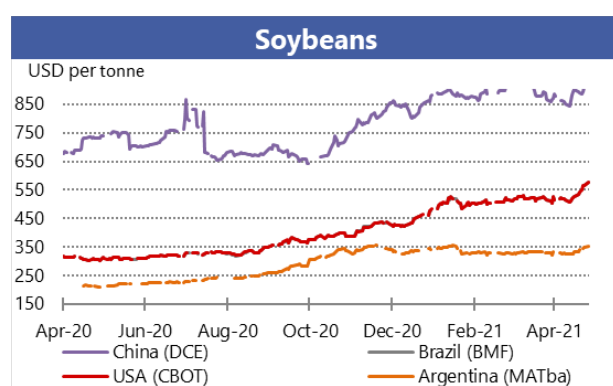
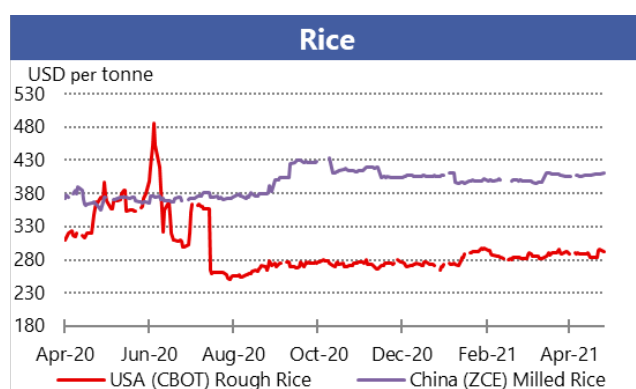
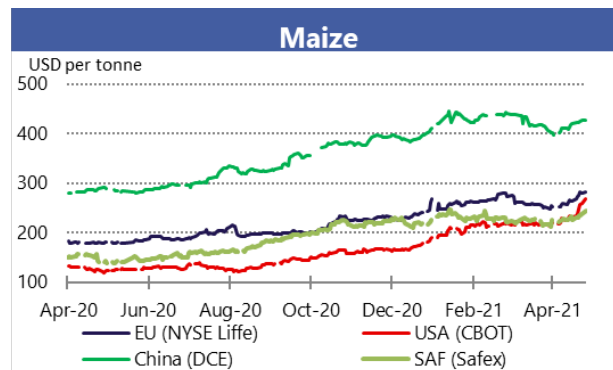
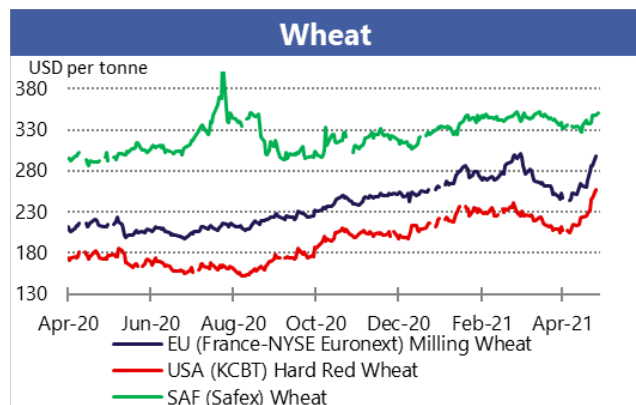
The forward curves for maize and soybeans displayed dynamic movement m/m. The front maize spread between the May and July futures reached USD 26 per tonne inversion [downward slope] while the May/July soybean spread attained USD 13.5 inversion. The July/December maize spread surged from about a USD 20 per tonne inversion to a USD 43 per tonne inversion, while the July and November soybean spread dropped from its record March inversion of USD 70 to USD 48 by mid-April and ended the month at USD 71. The high inversion levels were indicative of stock depletions along the Illinois River area, the most significant shipment corridor to the gulf export market and also the location for the maize and soybean delivery markets. Wheat forward curves remained generally flat.

Investment flows

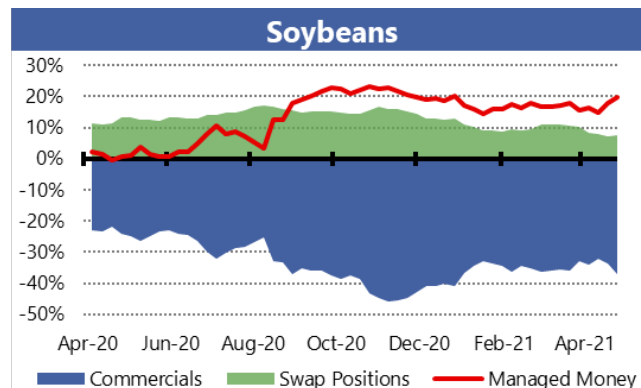
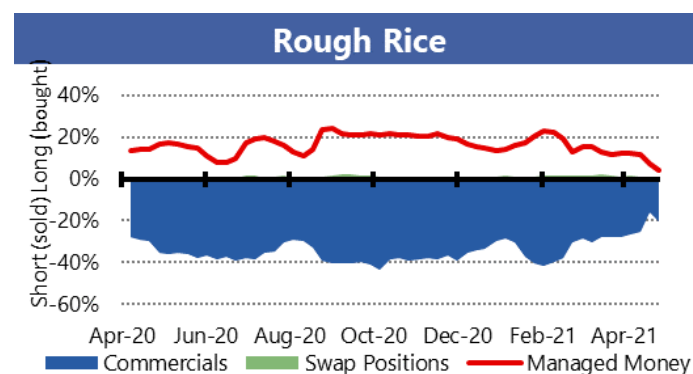
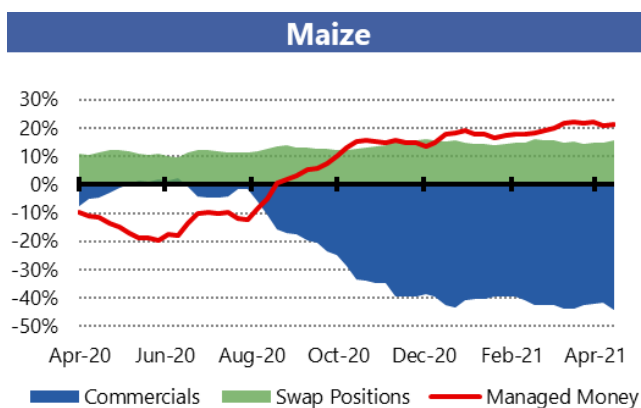
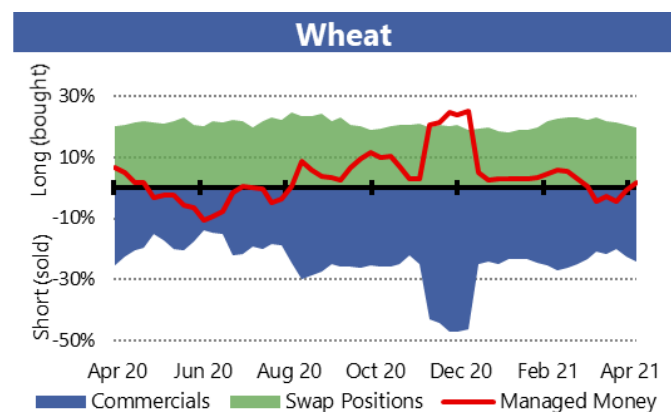
Managed money maintained its large net long positions in maize and soybeans m/m while keeping its neutral stance in wheat. Commercials remained net short m/m in all three commodities, while swaps dealers held their continuous long positions. Investment flows for the month seemed unaffected by the CME increases in position limits.

Market indicators

Daily quotations from leading exchanges - nearby futures

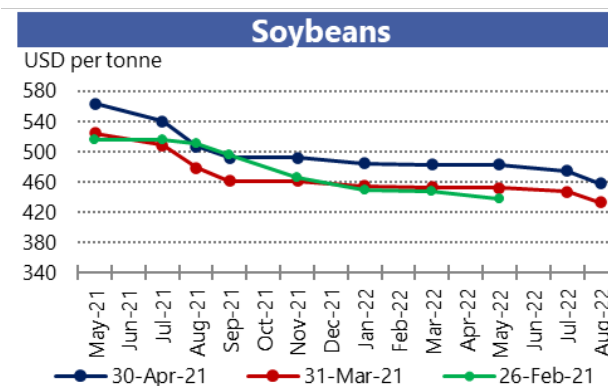
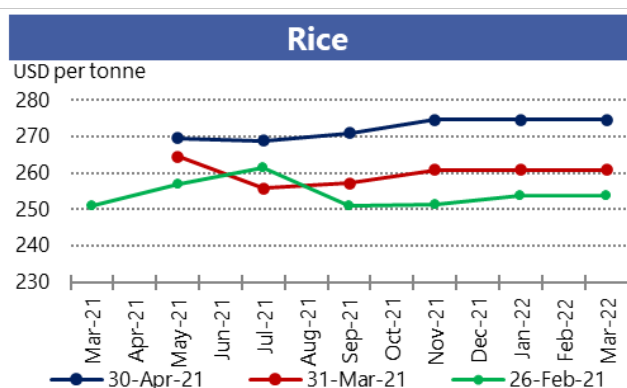
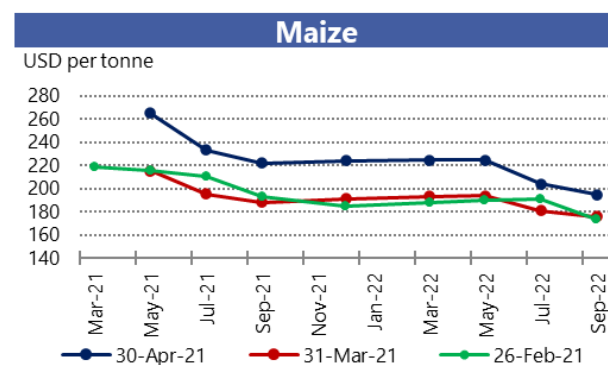
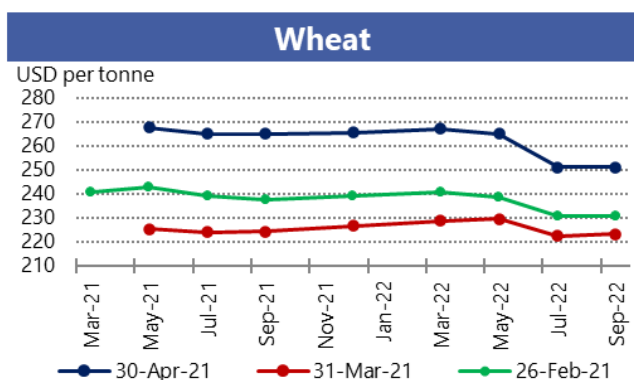


CFTC Commitments of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as percentage of Open Interest*

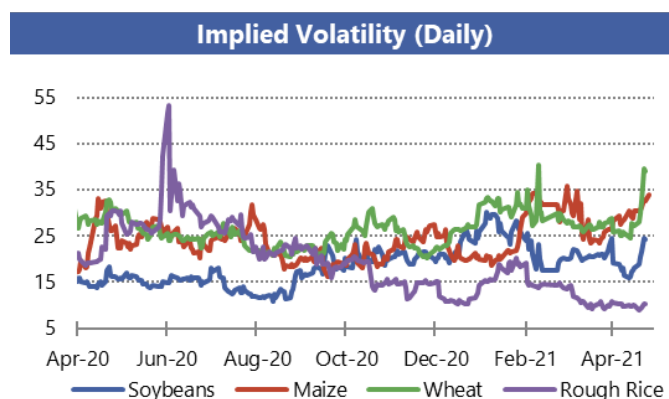
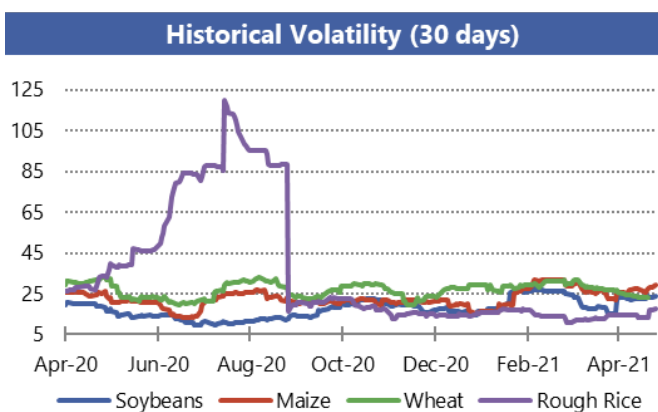


*Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.

Forward Curves



Historical and Implied Volatilities

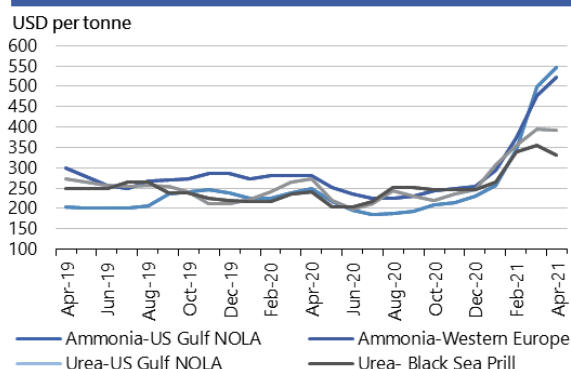

 AMIS Market indicators

Some of the indicators covered in this report are updated regularly on the AMIS website. These, as well as other market indicators, can be found at: <http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring/indicators/>

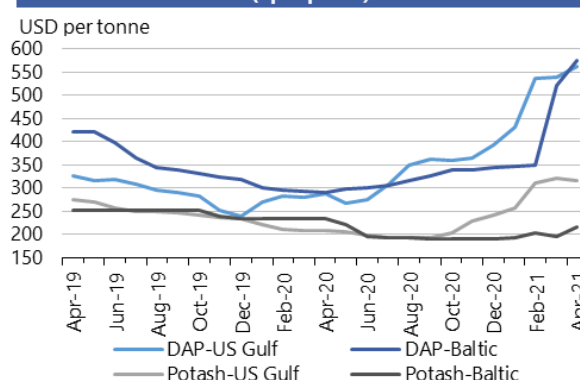
*For more information about Forward Curves see the feature article in [No. 75 February AMIS Market Monitor 2020](#).

Fertilizer outlook

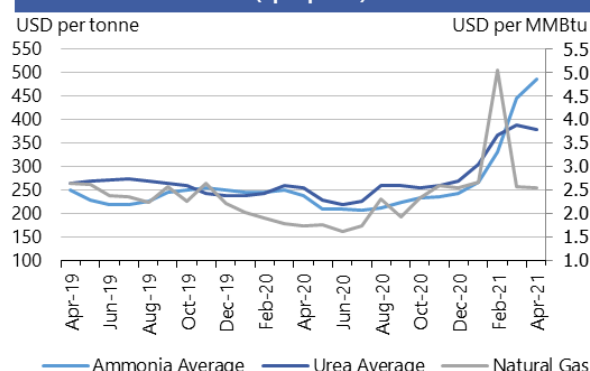
**Ammonia and Urea
(Spot prices)**



**Potash and Phosphate
(Spot prices)**



**Ammonia Average, Urea Average and Natural Gas
(Spot prices)**



Note: Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers. Own elaboration based on Bloomberg.

- The movements in **fertilizers prices** were mixed in April, but most prices remained above last year levels.
- **Natural gas** prices slightly decreased due to warmer weather in the northern hemisphere and consequent lower energy demand.
- **Ammonia** prices continued their upward trend due to higher demand ahead of application season combined with a limited supply, particularly from the US and Russia.
- **Urea** prices stabilized in the US and decreased in the Black Sea region due to low spring demand.
- **DAP** prices increased markedly, especially in the Baltics, due to higher demand from India and Europe.
- Slowdown in application in the US pushed **potash prices** down, as opposed to the Baltics where prices increased.

	April average	April std. dev	% change last month*	% change last year*	12-month high	12-month low
Ammonia-US Gulf NOLA	545.0	-	9.3%	118.0%	545.0	186.0
Ammonia-Western Europe	522.5	15.0	9.4%	86.6%	523.0	225.0
Urea-US Gulf	392.5	16.6	-0.4%	43.9%	394.0	199.5
Urea-Black Sea	331.5	7.5	-6.5%	38.1%	354.5	203.0
DAP-US Gulf	561.5	13.5	4.2%	95.0%	561.5	267.0
DAP-Baltic	575.0	-	10.3%	97.4%	575.0	299.0
Potash-Baltic	215.5	15.8	9.7%	-8.1%	221.0	190.0
Potash- US Gulf NOLA	317.3	1.5	-1.3%	51.4%	321.5	193.0
Ammonia	486.6	7.0	9.6%	105.4%	486.6	206.5
Urea	378.1	9.5	-2.3%	48.3%	387.1	217.0
Natural Gas	2.5	0.1	-0.8%	46.9%	5.0	1.6

All prices shown are in US dollars.

Source: Own elaboration based on Bloomberg



Chart and tables description * Estimated using available weekly data to date.

Ammonia and Urea: Overview of nitrogen-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Western Europe and Black Sea. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Potash and Phosphate: Overview of phosphate and potassium-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Baltic and Vancouver. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Ammonia Average and Urea Average: Monthly average prices from Ammonia's US Gulf NOLA, Middle East, Black Sea and Western Europe were averaged to obtain Ammonia Average prices; monthly average prices from Urea's US Gulf NOLA, US Gulf Prill, Middle East Prill, Black Sea Prill and Mediterranean were averaged to obtain Urea Average prices.

Natural Gas: Henry Hub Natural Gas Spot Price from ICE up to December 2017 and from Bloomberg (BGAP) from January 2018 onwards. Prices are intraday prices averaged by month. Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers

DAP: Diammonium Phosphate.

Ocean freight markets

Dry bulk freight market developments

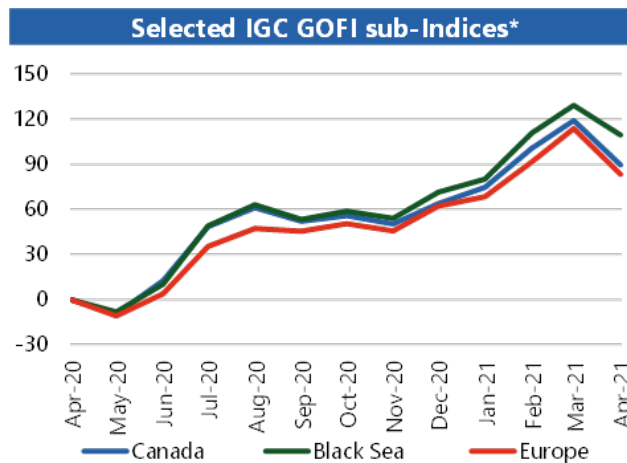
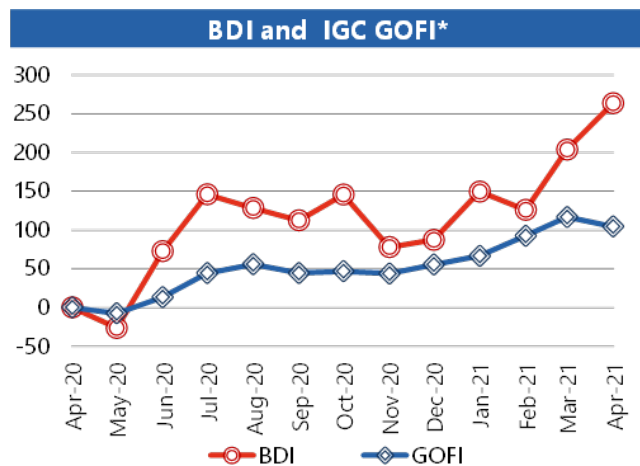
	April-21 average	Change m/m	Change y/y
Baltic Dry Index (BDI)*	2413.4	+19.6%	+263.5%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
<i>Capesize</i>	3455.1	+68.7%	+376.0%
<i>Panamax</i>	2365.8	-5.6%	+201.6%
<i>Supramax</i>	1904.3	-5.0%	+342.6%
Baltic Handysize Index (BHSI)**	1060.5	-14.2%	+270.1%

Sources: Baltic Exchange, IGC.

*4 January 1985 = 1000. **23 May 2006 = 1000.

***1 January 2013 = 100.

	April-21 average	Change m/m	Change y/y
IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)***	161.5	-5.7%	+104.5%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
<i>Argentina</i>	203.4	-7.4%	+102.3%
<i>Australia</i>	128.9	-4.3%	+162.7%
<i>Brazil</i>	218.2	-2.4%	+114.1%
<i>Black Sea</i>	162.1	-8.6%	+109.6%
<i>Canada</i>	119.5	-13.4%	+89.7%
<i>Europe</i>	127.4	-14.2%	+83.4%
<i>US</i>	130.4	-7.7%	+89.5%



*percentage change based on monthly average values

- Sentiment in the dry bulk freight market remained generally buoyant during April. Linked to rallying Capesize earnings, average **Baltic Dry Index (BDI)** values were nearly one-fifth higher m/m, at a decade high. Average earnings in the grains and oilseeds carrying sectors were softer, albeit all three markets saw a marked improvement in vessel earnings in the latter half of the period.
- Average **Capesize** rates posted a 69 percent monthly increase, to reach a 19-month peak. Sustained underpinning stemmed from strong market fundamentals, mainly tied to robust iron ore demand from China, where steel production continued to expand despite surging raw material prices. Cyclone-induced logistical disruptions in Western Australia likely offered early support.
- The **Panamax** market initially dipped, weighed by reduced mineral demand in Asia and a slowdown in trade in the Atlantic, although there was offsetting support

from sustained grains and oilseeds activity out of the northern Pacific. Some recovery was noted thereafter on improved coal activity in Asia and new enquiries at the US Gulf and in South America, including for grains, although increasing flows of ballasting vessels to the Atlantic trimmed overall advances in that Basin, with the Baltic sub-Index quoted 6 percent lower m/m on average.

- An oversupply of tonnage at the US Gulf, coupled with softer rates in South America and the Mediterranean, contributed to initial weakness in **Supramax** and **Handysize** markets. Nonetheless, declines in average values were capped by relatively stronger fundamentals in the Pacific, while corresponding sector Indices averaged 5 and 14 percent lower m/m, respectively.
- Average bunker prices firmed slightly during the past month, but softer time charter values led to declines in all sub-Indices of the **IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)**, which averaged 6 percent lower m/m, but remained more than two times higher y/y.



Source: International Grains Council

Baltic Dry Index (BDI): A benchmark indicator issued daily by the Baltic Exchange, providing assessed costs of moving raw materials on ocean going vessels. Comprises sub-Indices for three segments: Capesize, Panamax and Supramax. The Baltic Handysize Index excluded from the BDI from 1 March 2018.

IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI): A trade-weighted composite measure of ocean freight costs for grains and oilseeds, issued daily by the International Grains Council. Includes sub-Indices for seven main origins (Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Black Sea, Canada, the EU and the USA). Constructed based on nominal HSS (heavy grains, soybeans, sorghum) voyage rates on selected major routes.

Capesize: Vessels with deadweight tonnage (DWT) above 80,000 DWT, primarily transporting coal, iron ore and other heavy raw materials on long-haul routes.

Panamax: Carriers with capacity of 60,000-80,000 DWT, mostly geared to transporting coal, grains, oilseeds and other bulks, including sugar and cement.

Supramax/Handysize: Ships with capacity below 60,000 DWT, accounting for the majority of the world's ocean-going vessels and able to transport a wide variety of cargos, including grains and oilseeds.

Explanatory notes

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of “Markets at a glance” reflect judgmental views that take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA. For the former, they also take into account information provided by AMIS focal points (hence the notion “FAO-AMIS”). World estimates and forecasts produced by the three sources may vary due to several reasons, such as varying release dates and different methodologies used in constructing commodity balances. Specifically:

Production: Wheat production data from all three sources refer to production occurring in the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. crops harvested in 2016 are allocated to the 2016/17 marketing season). Maize and rice production data for FAO-AMIS refer to crops harvested during the first year of the marketing season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season) in both the northern and southern hemisphere. Rice production data for FAO-AMIS also include northern hemisphere production from secondary crops harvested in the second year of the marketing season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). By contrast, rice and maize data for USDA and IGC encompass production in the northern hemisphere occurring during the first year of the season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season), as well as crops harvested in the southern hemisphere during the second year of the season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). For soybeans, the latter approach is used by all three sources.

Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks by all three sources.

Utilization: For all three sources, wheat, maize and rice utilization includes food, feed and other uses (namely, seeds, industrial uses and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. However, for all AMIS commodities, the use categories may be grouped differently across sources and may also include residual values.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June basis, except for USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. Wheat trade data from all three sources includes wheat flour in wheat grain equivalent, while the USDA also considers wheat products. For rice, trade covers shipments from January to December of the second year of the respective marketing season. For soybeans, trade is reported on an October/September basis by FAO-AMIS and the IGC, while USDA data are based on local marketing years except for Argentina and Brazil which are reported on an October/September basis. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Stocks: In general, world stocks of AMIS crops refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year. For soybeans, stock levels reported by the USDA are based on local marketing years, except for Argentina and Brazil, which are adjusted to October/September. For maize and rice, global estimates may vary across sources because of differences in the allocation of production in southern hemisphere countries.

For more information on AMIS Supply and Demand, please view [AMIS Supply and Demand Balances Manual](#).

Main sources

Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, IFPRI, IGC, OECD, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve, WTO

AMIS - GEOGLAM Crop Calendar

Selected leading producers

Wheat		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
EU (21%)*	winter												
China (17%)	spring												
	winter												
India (13%)	winter												
US (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Russia (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Maize		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
US (35%)													
China (22%)	north												
	south												
Brazil (8%)	1st crop												
	2nd crop												
EU (7%)													
Argentina (3%)													
Rice		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
China (29%)	intermediary crop												
	late crop												
	early crop												
India (21%)	kharif												
	rabi												
Indonesia (9%)	main Java												
	second Java												
Viet Nam (6%)	winter-spring												
	summer/autumn												
	winter												
Thailand (4%)	main season												
	second season												
Soybeans		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
USA (31%)													
Brazil (29%)													
Argentina (18%)													
China (4%)													
India (3%)													

* Percentages refer to the global share of production (average 2013-15).

	Planting (peak)		Harvest (peak)
	Planting		Harvest
	Weather conditions in this period are critical for yields.		Growing period

2021 AMIS Market Monitor Release Dates

February 4, March 4, April 8, May 6, June 3, July 8, September 2, October 7, November 4, December 2

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